short time. Hopefully, the attacker will become bored and go away or can be identified for action by law enforcement. Another possibility is to use viruses to generate the attack. If a virus is successful in spreading to thousands of sites on the Internet and is programmed to start an IP attack against a specific target on the same day at the same time then there is no way to stop the attack because it has originated from thousands of sites all of which are live hostages. The site under attack will have to go off line since the Internet service providers will be helpless in the face of a coordinated dispersed attack. Since the impact against each individual hostage system is low, the hostages may not even notice that there is a problem. The Internet service provider attached to the target system is in the best position to detect the attack, however, they are as subject to this attack as the target since they may 'crash' from the excessive bandwidth usage flooding their network from multiple sources.

Scenario Of A Virus Attack Against A Secure Unix Network

The military and many other companies believe that they are protected against focused attacks because they employ a closed network configuration. In some cases these networks may also use highly secure 'B' rated operating systems [NCSC-TG-006]. Typically, the network will not allow modems, Internet connections or have any electronic connections to organizations outside of the immediate need. In addition, the networks are almost always heterogeneous because of legacy equipment, primarily PC systems. The network designers normally allow the PC systems to retain their floppy disk drives even thought their attachment to a network renders them nonessential. Networks of this type have been considered secure, however, they are open to information warfare attacks via a focused virus. Assuming that the propitiator is an outsider without access to the equipment or premises, one possible method of attack against this type of network would take advantage of both the Typhoid Mary Syndrome and Trans-platform Viruses to produce an attack that is targeted against the Unix systems but origi-